

Name: _____

Date: _____

Class: _____

MyDesign Portfolio

Element A Initial Template

Element A: Presentation and Justification of the Problem

Problem Statement and Details (A1, A2, A5)

There are two rabbits living at Piedmont Wildlife Center with a hideaway in their enclosure that is inefficient for the employees there, and not suitable for the rabbits themselves. The hideaway is bulky and heavy, making it hard to move and clean for the employees. It has metal hinges and pieces that could cut the rabbits. It also has no cushion on the bottom for the rabbits' comfortability. It is not very enriching, as there is little variety or activities the rabbits can do with it, for example, burrowing, or chewing. It is also hard to see and check on the rabbits.

Stakeholder Concerns and Connections (A3, A4)

Directly indicate at least five primary stakeholders or stakeholder groups. These are the people most directly impacted by the problem. Highlight the concerns of your primary stakeholders and use that to justify why there is a need to address the problem. Consider the breadth of the problem and how it might have social and environmental impacts on secondary stakeholders, which are people who may be impacted by a solution to the problem and are still part of the system.

Problem Importance (A6)

This problem is important and should have a solution because it will be beneficial for the employees at Piedmont Wildlife Center, and the 2 rabbits living there. A solution to this problem should be easier to move for the employees, comfortable and safe for the rabbits, and easier to see the rabbits for visitors and employees. They currently have a wooden structure that is not suitable for their comfortability or safety. It is also bulky, hard to move, not well ventilated, and makes it hard to see or check up on the rabbits. The wood bottom should be a softer material, shown under "Environment" on this website. The metal on the original poses a threat to the safety of the rabbits because they have sharp edges which could cut the rabbits. This website shows how rabbits like to burrow, so they should have

Name: _____

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more options to do so. This problem should be solved in consideration of these factors to provide efficiency for the employees, and the best environment for the rabbits.

<https://journal.iaabcfoundation.org/pet-rabbits-research-warranted-behavior-husbandry/>

<https://binkybunny.com/forums/topic/what-is-your-bunnys-favorite-hideae/>

<https://oxbowanimalhealth.com/blog/what-materials-are-safe-for-rabbits-to-chew/>

<https://agriculture.vic.gov.au/livestock-and-animals/animal-welfare-victoria/other-pets/rabbits/petcare-practices-research-results-for-rabbits-owners>

<https://rabbitwelfare.co.uk/digging/>

